

1. Ephesians 2:8–9

Verses

- **1611 KJV:** "For by grace are ye saved through faith; and **that** not of yourselves: **it** is the gift of God: Not of works, lest any man should boast."
- **TR (Beza 1598):** τῇ γὰρ χάριτί ἐστε σεσωσμένοι διὰ τῆς πίστεως· καὶ τοῦτο οὐκ ἐξ ὑμῶν· θεοῦ τὸ δῶρον·

Greek Grammatical Proof (Gender Mismatch)

1. χάριτί ("grace") → Dative, **Feminine**, Singular (3rd word).
2. πίστεως ("faith") → Genitive, **Feminine**, Singular (7th word).
3. τοῦτο ("that") → Nominative/Accusative, **Neuter**, Singular (9th word).

In Greek syntax, a demonstrative pronoun must agree in gender with its noun antecedent. Because πίστεως ("faith") is feminine and τοῦτο ("that") is neuter, τοῦτο cannot grammatically refer to "faith." Instead, the neuter pronoun refers back to the entire preceding clause as an abstract concept: the entire process of being saved by grace through faith.

English Grammatical Proof (Clause Anaphora & Parallel Modifiers)

1. **Clause-Level Anaphora:** In English syntax, when "that" introduces a parenthetical coordinate clause ("*and that not of yourselves*") followed by "*it is the gift of God*," the pronouns "that" and "it" function as clause-level pronouns. If "that" modified "faith" specifically, standard syntax would require a relative pronoun ("*through faith, which is not of yourselves*").
2. **Parallel Prepositional Modifiers:** Verse 9 attaches a second parallel prepositional phrase to the same antecedent: "*Not of works*." In Biblical English, faith is contrasted *against* works (e.g., Romans 3:28), whereas **salvation** is "not of works." Because both "not of yourselves" (v. 8) and "not of works" (v. 9) modify the same referent, the referent must be the full predicate "*by grace are ye saved through faith*."

Conclusive Resolution

Both Greek gender agreement rules and English clause structures strictly forbid "faith" from being the isolated antecedent of "that." Both tongues lock "that/it" to the overarching gift of salvation by grace through faith.

2. Acts 2:38

Verses

- **1611 KJV:** "Then Peter said unto them, **Repent**, and **be baptized every one of you** in the name of Jesus Christ **for the remission of sins**, and **ye shall receive** the gift of the Holy Ghost."
- **TR (Beza 1598):** Πέτρος δὲ ἔφη πρὸς αὐτούς, **Μετανοήσατε**, καὶ **βαπτισθήτω ἕκαστος ὑμῶν** ἐπὶ τῷ ὀνόματι Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ εἰς ἄφεσιν ἁμαρτιῶν· καὶ **λήψεσθε** τὴν δωρεὰν τοῦ Ἁγίου Πνεύματος.

Greek Grammatical Proof (Verbal Person/Number Framing)

1. **Μετανοήσατε** ("Repent") → Aorist Active Imperative, **2nd Person Plural**.
2. **βαπτισθήτω ἕκαστος** ("be baptized every one") → Aorist Passive Imperative, **3rd Person Singular** (**βαπτισθήτω**) + Nominative **Masculine Singular** Indefinite Pronoun (**ἕκαστος**).
3. **λήψεσθε** ("ye shall receive") → Future Middle Deponent Indicative, **2nd Person Plural**.

The main sentence structure is driven by the 2nd-person plural frame: **Μετανοήσατε** (plural command) ... **λήψεσθε** (plural promise). The phrase **εἰς ἄφεσιν ἁμαρτιῶν** ("for the remission of sins") anchors back to the primary 2nd-person plural command ("Repent ye"), while the 3rd-person singular command (**βαπτισθήτω ἕκαστος**) stands as a parenthetical individual instruction inserted within that plural address.

English Grammatical Proof (Narrative Frame & Prepositional Attachment)

1. **Plural Narrative Frame:** English imperatives track person and number explicitly:
 - **"Repent"** = Plural command addressed to the whole crowd (*"Repent [ye]"*).
 - **"every one of you"** = Distributive Singular subject governing *"be baptized"*.
 - **"ye shall receive"** = 2nd-Person Plural pronoun (*"ye [all]"*).
2. **Prepositional Attachment:** In English compound sentence logic, when a main plural command ("Repent") is separated from a plural promise ("ye shall receive") by an inserted singular directive ("be baptized every one of you"), the primary purpose clause ("**for the remission of sins**") attaches to the primary plural command that governs the entire assembly ("Repent").

Conclusive Resolution

Both Greek verbal parsing and English pronoun framing isolate "be baptized every one of you" as a 3rd-person singular insertion. Remission of sins is grammatically locked to the 2nd-person plural command "Repent."

3. Matthew 16:18

Verses

- **1611 KJV:** "And I say also unto **thee**, That **thou** art **Peter**, and upon **this rock** I will build my church; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it."
- **TR (Beza 1598):** κάγω δέ σοι λέγω ὅτι σὺ εἶ Πέτρος, καὶ ἐπὶ ταύτῃ τῇ πέτρᾳ οἰκοδομήσω μου τὴν ἐκκλησίαν, καὶ πύλαι ᾗτου οὐ κατισχύσουσιν αὐτῆς.

Greek Grammatical Proof (Gender Barrier)

1. Πέτρος ("Peter") → Proper Noun, Nominative, **Masculine**, Singular.
2. ταύτῃ τῇ πέτρᾳ ("this rock") → Demonstrative Pronoun + Noun, Dative, **Feminine**, Singular.

In Greek, if the demonstrative pronoun ταύτῃ ("this") were intended to point directly to the masculine proper noun Πέτρος, syntax strictly required the masculine demonstrative τοῦτῳ ("upon this [man]"). The deliberate shift to the feminine demonstrative phrase ταύτῃ τῇ πέτρᾳ creates a structural barrier, referring back instead to the feminine concept of Peter's confession in verse 16 or to Christ Himself.

English Grammatical Proof (Person Shift & Proximal Demonstrative)

1. **Shift in Personal Address:** Jesus addresses Peter directly using 2nd-person pronouns: "*unto **thee***" and "***thou** art Peter.*" Had Jesus intended to identify Peter as the foundational rock, standard English syntax for direct address required continuing the 2nd-person pronoun: "*and upon **thee** I will build my church.*" Shifting to the 3rd-person phrase "*this rock*" breaks direct address and points to a different subject.
2. **Proximal Demonstrative Alignment:** "This" is a proximal demonstrative adjective pointing to the immediate topic of discourse. In context, two entities exist: Peter (addressed directly as "thou") and the revealed truth of Christ's identity (v. 16–17: "*Thou art the Christ... flesh and blood hath not revealed **it** unto thee*"). Because "thou" is locked to Peter, "this rock" points back to the revealed truth of Christ's deity.

Conclusive Resolution

The Greek gender shift (Πέτρος vs. πέτρᾳ) and the English person shift ("thou" vs. "this rock") both independently forbid identifying Peter as the rock upon which the Church is built.